

will have you tearing your hair out.

The most common connectivity problem occurs with one access point and one client device. For this you should use the checklist in the answer above to solve your problem.

When the network is a little bigger, and you have, say, four access points connecting 12 client machines, and some connect fine while others don't, you begin to feel the throbbing of the veins in your temple. The first step is to calm down and start thinking logically again. Ask yourself a simple question, "Is there a pattern here?".

What you need to do is visualise the layout of your mansion (you would need one to have this many access points and client PCs) or office. If all the computers that can't seem to connect, or are getting miserable network speeds, are located in the same overall geographical area, then you know the access point that they're supposed to be connecting to is to blame. The first thing to do is to make sure it's switched on! Sure this sounds silly, but you won't believe the number of network administrators who have kicked themselves repeatedly in the backside because they didn't think of checking such a basic problem. If it's all powered up and tells you via its LEDs that it's ready and rearing to go, you can bet it's probably a simple configuration error. Check the SSID! A little typo or misplaced capital letter can cause you much pain.

The next step is to look for other devices that might cause interference in the particular area of the building where the problem occurs, such as an evil giant microwave, or a powerful cordless phone that someone thought looked good placed on top of your access point!

No? All right then, try pinging the access point from a wireless client. If it pings, but you cannot connect to it from a wired client, go and check that the Ethernet cable is plugged in properly, think of yourself wearing a "Kick Me" sign for the rest of the week, that ought to give you the energy to go back and check the cable.